ISSUE #2

OCTOBER 2025

Holly Road & East Park Parade
Residents Association

HELLO NEIGHBOURS!

What a fantastic summer we've had! Our street party was a huge success—thank you to everyone who came along, contributed, and made it such a joyful day. Together we not only celebrated our community spirit but also raised funds for our Residents' Association.
These funds will go straight back into making our service road a nicer place to be, with plans for planting and improving the look of the area. Even better, they'll also help us organise more social events, giving us more opportunities to connect, celebrate, and enjoy our neighbourhood together.
Here's to keeping the momentum going and making our community thrive!

Our **next community meeting will take place on the 30th of April, 7pm at the Picturedrome.** Join us to shape up this neighbourhood together!

GRANT & ALLEYWAY UPDATE

Over the past few months, a small group of neighbours have worked hard to clear weeds and tidy the service road—transforming it from overgrown to welcoming. The before-and-after photos show just how much has been achieved, and it's something we can all be proud of. To keep it looking its best, we ask everyone to **spend a few minutes maintaining the section outside their property**—together, small efforts make a big difference.
We're also excited to announce that **we've been awarded a £200 "Northampton in Bloom" grant**! This will go towards planting flowers and bulbs along the service road, bringing colour and life all year round. Donations of plants, bulbs, seeds, planters, or gardening materials are very welcome—every contribution will help make our shared space brighter and more vibrant for the whole community.

LITTER PICKING

Join us at 10am on the **1st Saturday every month** to get involved and contribute to litter picking the service road and our roads to make where we live a nicer place.
Bring your own bin bags and litter picking grabber if you have one!

ACTION FOR HAPPINESS

Action for Happiness Northamptonshire Hub (AfHNH) is developing into a local charity under the national movement, supporting the pledge "to increase happiness and reduce unhappiness in the world." We meet locally and share free national resources for all ages.
We're seeking partners with Heather's Place, a Happy Café in Kingsley, as well as local champions and volunteers to spread these resources through training and community action.
Get involved by downloading the Action for Happiness app, trying the free 10 Days of Happiness course, printing the monthly calendar (available in 32 languages), or exploring expert talks. Share with friends and family—'the best way to cheer yourself up is to cheer someone else up' - Mark Twain.

🌍 Main Linktree: https://linktr.ee/a4hnorthants

A WORD FROM DAVID SMART ABOUT DELAPRE ABBEY PRESERVATION TRUST AND THE PAVILLION

'As a Trustee, I've reviewed the draft consultation on future uses of the Pavilion site, building on earlier feedback (including from Friends of Northampton Racecourse). The process is slightly delayed as we brought in partners to help create a plan that better meets community needs. Once approved by the Council, the consultation will be circulated, and we hope to share it at our upcoming community meeting for face-to-face discussion.
The DAPT team is excited to work with the community on this project and hopes WNC will grant full use of the Pavilion so we can also seek funding for its restoration. Please do take part in the consultation—it's your chance to shape the future of the Pavilion.'

USEFUL LINKS

- Friends of Northampton Racecourse
- Holly Road/ East Park Parade Facebook
- Neighbourhood Watch Group

Action for Happiness Website

BOOK CLUB

Our book club is well underway!
We've already met twice to discuss **Eden Close by Anita Shreve** and **Demon Copperhead by Barbara Kingsolver.**

Come join us for our next read—just join the Newsletter group in our WhatsApp Community or contact Marion**: +44 7493 900948**

ALLEYWAY SAFETY ADVICES FROM BRENDA HART, CRIME PREVENTION OFFICER

- **Maintenance**: A tidy, well-kept alley encourages ownership, deters crime, and improves the environment. A small group has already cleared weeds and started a litter rota—wider involvement would spread the load and strengthen community engagement.
- **Security**: CCTV has limits (no real-time monitoring, can be obscured, signage required) but may help with vehicle registrations or historic crimes. Lighting is only effective at entry/exit points, where cameras and signs could deter offenders and support fly-tipping prevention. See Secured by Design for guidance.
- **Garage Security:** Residents are advised to improve garage safety (e.g. "garage defender" devices, extending alarms). Individual guidance is available from the crime prevention officer.
- **Community Safety:** The community warden can help with removing needles/drug paraphernalia and raising Council awareness.
- **Crime Reporting**: Residents should report all incidents online and keep the crime reference number—this ensures issues are recorded, acted on, and local policing reflects real needs.

EYES ON THE STREET

In our meta-analysis of 15 experiments from 13 research papers we report a reduction in the risk of antisocial behaviour of 35% when eye cues are present. By contrast, systematic reviews have suggested **CCTV** cameras reduce crime by only 16%.
https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S1090513817303264

Bill Pollard Artist and resident EPP

• Bill graciously is willing to offer his time for free however would need materials which could be paint from Abington decorator suppliers and ply board from the Rock Bottom. We could see whether they are willing to provide community discount- (he thinks they may..) material costs 8 or so boards around £150 (direct contribution).
• Need permission to erect, agree sites, supported by lighting and cameras
• Can be discussed at community meeting

SEMILONG GREEN SPACES: A TESTAMENT TO COMMUNITY RESILIENCE

In less than a year, a small group of dedicated volunteers transformed a fly-tipped, graffiti-covered site into a vibrant community garden with eight themed sections. The journey has been far from easy — five incidents of vandalism, persistent fly-tipping, and drug dealing just outside the garden tested the team's resolve. But the community stood firm. With paintbrushes, plants, and perseverance, they reclaimed the space for creativity, connection, and care.
Semilong Green Spaces now stands as a powerful symbol of what's possible when people come together with vision, courage, and an unshakable belief in positive change.

HALLOWEEN CONTEST AND GATHERING

This Halloween, our service road is turning into a spooky wonderland! Join us on **Saturday, 25th October from 2pm** for an afternoon of pumpkin carving, creative decorating, and delicious hot drinks to keep you warm. Bring the whole family and enjoy some Halloween magic with your neighbours—giggles, spooky surprises, and community fun are guaranteed! And keep your eyes peeled—the best-decorated house will win a special prize. Come along and help us make this Halloween a memorable celebration for everyone!

PUBLICATION

If you too want to create a social group, have an announcement to make, friendly advice to give, or want to advertise in this newsletter (£5/advert) send us your article at:

NN1serviceroad@outlook.co.uk